

The internet and the world wide web

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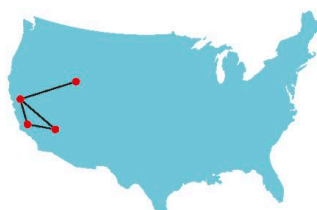
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People often use the terms **internet** and **world wide web** interchangeably. In reality, they're two separate concepts: one is a network and the other is a file system.

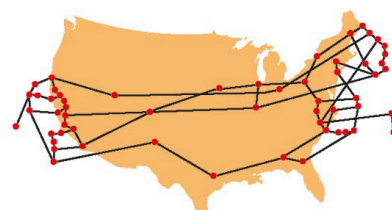
The internet

The internet is a massive global network created from connections between billions of devices. The term refers to hardware devices and their capacity to connect and exchange data. In 2017, it was estimated that 51 per cent of the world is online – more than 3.5 billion people. There are internet users in every country on every continent, and the net's only getting bigger and faster.

History



ARPANET in 1969



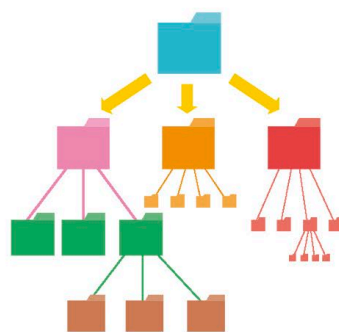
ARPANET in 1977

In 1969, the Advanced Research Projects Agency Network (ARPANET) connected four west-coast American universities using phone lines. By the late 1970s, more universities and private corporations had been added, so that ARPANET stretched right across the country. During the 1990s, individuals began to connect, prompting the net to become more commerce-oriented.

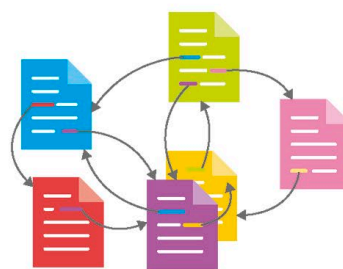
The world wide web

The world wide web is like a global filing system that runs on the internet. Each entry in this filing system is a website, which can consist of many webpages. Each webpage brings code, text, and multimedia files together. Hyperlinks are special interconnections between webpages that help users navigate through the world wide web.

History



Files stored in tree structure



Documents connected with hyperlinks

As the internet grew it became difficult to find information. Data was stored in a tree structure, the way files are stored on personal computer. In 1989, English engineer Tim Berners-Lee (b. 1955) came up with a solution to flatten the tree by making related files link to each other with clickable hyperlinks. This meant that to find something, users could simply jump from one relevant document to the next, instead of backtracking through a maze of folders.